

Abdulla Abdulrahman Y. AlBassam

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EDUCATION

Northumbria University, Newcastle

July 2026

BSc (Honours), Networks and Cyber Security
First Class Honours

King's College London

June 2023

Foundation Year
Economics and Mathematics

Modern Knowledge Schools, Bahrain

May 2022

American High School Diploma
GPA: 98%

EXPERIENCE

Investcorp | Information Security Assurance Intern | Jul 2026 – Aug 2026

- Operating Sophos XDR Powered by Secureworks (Taegis XDR) to monitor, triage, and investigate security alerts.
- Supporting email security with Proofpoint TAP and CTR, alongside control testing, risk assessment, compliance review, and SailPoint IAM workflows.

HONOURS AND AWARDS:

- Emdad Scholarship Recipient | 2022–2026
- Innovation Award | Anthropic x Accenture Hackathon | May 2026

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages and Scripting: Python, JavaScript/TypeScript, Swift, Rust, React (Native), Next.js, PHP, HTML, Bash, SQL.

Virtualisation and Supplementary Tools: Docker, VMware, Git/GitHub, Microsoft Office.

Security and Networking: Wireshark, Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, Snort, iptables, Hydra; GNS3, Cisco Packet Tracer, Kali Linux.

AI/ML: Jupyter, Google Colab, pandas, NumPy, scikit-learn; PyTorch/Transformers, Claude Code, Claude API (agentic tool use).

PROJECTS

Local Mail Server with Cascade AI Spam Filter | Bachelor's Dissertation | Sep 2025 – May 2026

- Built a secure local email system integrating baseline and advanced spam filters via a mlter pipeline to evaluate robustness against adversarial attacks.
- Hardened the mail transport with TLS and enforced SPF, DKIM, and DMARC checks to authenticate senders and block spoofed mail.

Enterprise Networking | Oct 2025 – Jan 2026

- Designed and simulated a multi-site enterprise WAN in GNS3 using an MPLS VPN core with dynamic routing, adding a direct IPsec VPN between critical sites to balance security and performance.

CTFs, Penetration Testing, and Defensive Security | Dec 2025 – Present

- Conducted vulnerability assessments on Vuln VMs and OWASP Juice Shop using tools such as Nmap, and Burp Suite. Reported findings, impact, and remediation.
- Implemented defensive controls (iptables rulesets, Snort IDS/IPS rules, OS hardening) and executed controlled credential testing with Hydra.
- Independently completed offensive security CTF challenges including Windows/Linux exploitation, privilege escalation, web application attacks, and password cracking.

URL Triage Agent | May 2026

- Built an autonomous AI agent that triages URLs running on a tool-use loop over ten investigative tools (WHOIS, DNS, TLS, etc...).
- Returns an analyst-grade verdict, confidence score, and evidence, turning minutes of manual SOC triage into seconds.

Digital Forensics Investigation | Feb 2025 – May 2025

- Carried out a forensic examination of two devices to recover all relevant evidence and further understand the suspect's motives, goals and objectives. Identified and evaluated findings from forensics investigations on FTK & Autopsy applying appropriate legal and procedural principles.

Computing Consultancy | Client Deliverable | Jan 2025 – May 2025

- Assessed a small Newcastle business's security posture and delivered actionable vulnerability assessment in a client-facing consulting capacity.

Sweaty: Video Game Social Platform | Oct 2025 – Present

- Building a social platform mobile app to track what you're playing, rate games, write reviews and share your gaming journey. Full-stack TypeScript across a React Native client, a Next.js 16 web layer on Vercel, and Postgres handling auth, storage, real-time interactions and activity feed.
- Security as a focus: row-level security on every Postgres table, server-side session validation, HMAC-signed OAuth.
- Self-Audited the codebase, closing IDOR, PostgREST injection and email-enumeration vulnerabilities.

Side Projects | 2025 – Present

- Shipped a range of full-stack side projects: a native macOS ad blocker (Swift, Rust via FFI), a manifesto-cited UK-politics explainer (FastAPI, React, Claude API), a gamified cybersecurity learning platform (JavaScript), and a personal portfolio site (Astro, Svelte, Tailwind).

INDUSTRY CERTIFICATIONS

CCNA: Networking, Security & Automation

Cisco | January 2026

CC: Certified in Cybersecurity

ISC2 | August 2025

eJPT: Junior Penetration Tester

INE | In progress